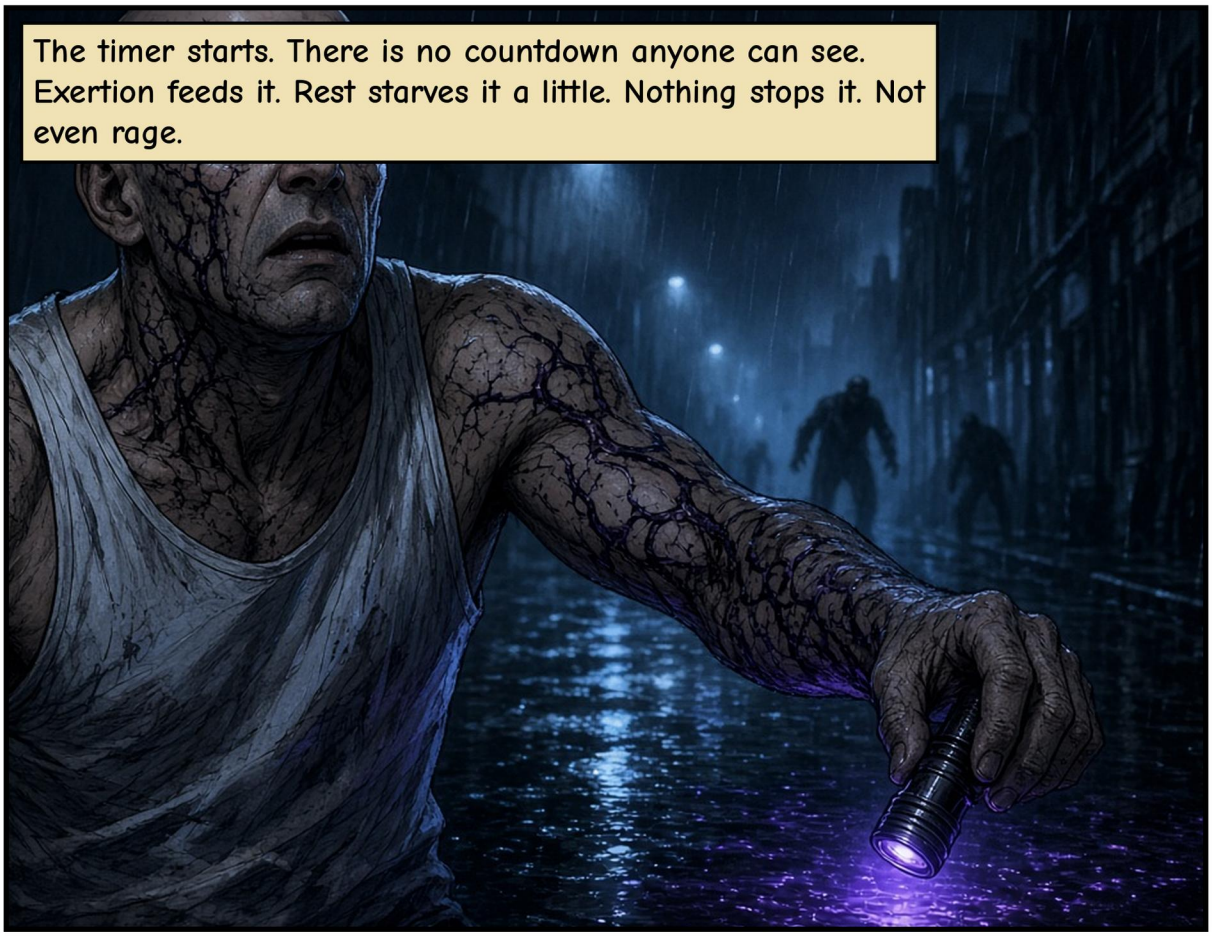
SOLACE

THE LIGHT STAYS ON



CHAOTIC DESIGNS

ISSUE #6


The timer starts. There is no countdown anyone can see. Exertion feeds it. Rest starves it a little. Nothing stops it. Not even rage.

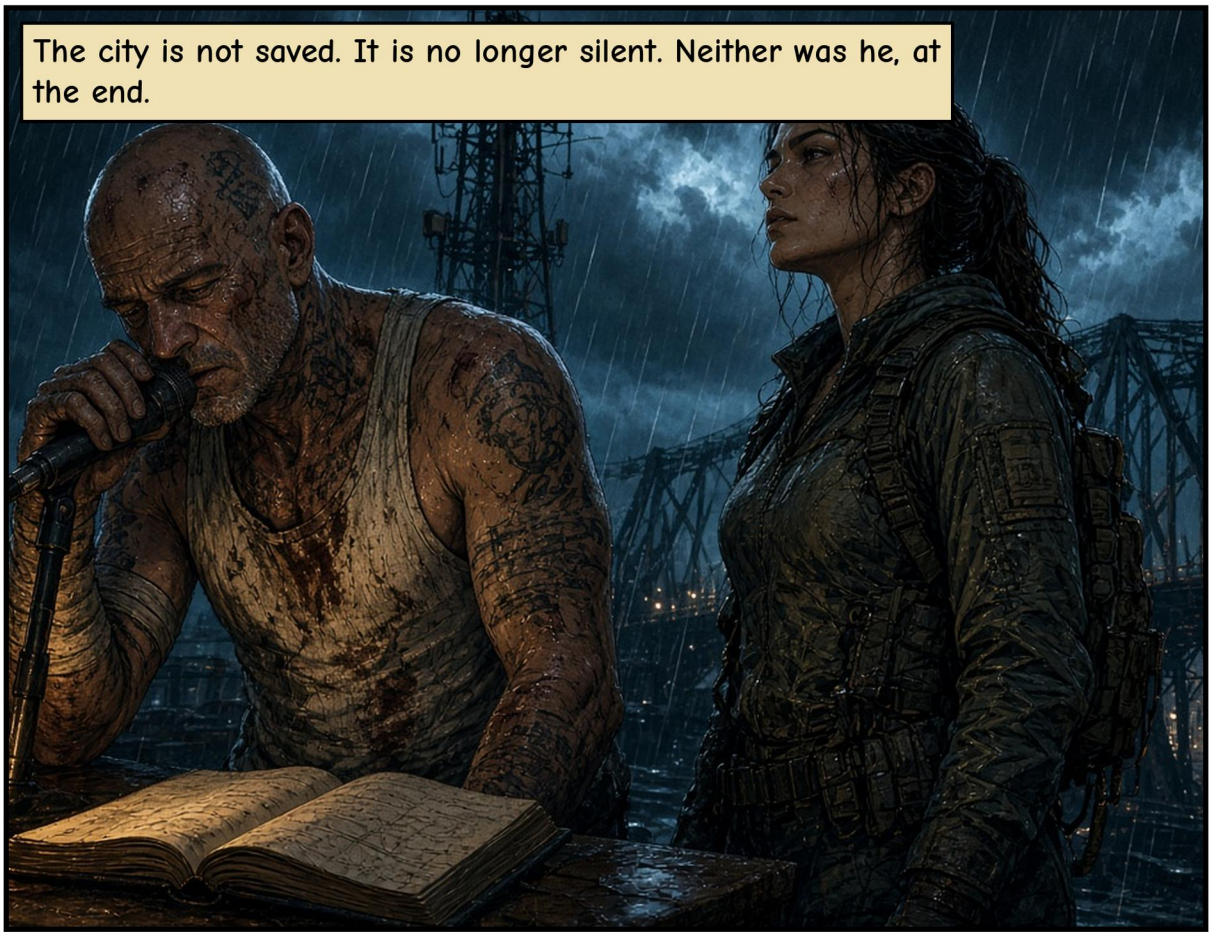

MISSY
YOUR HANDS. LOOK AT ME. YOUR HANDS ARE SHAKING AND YOU'RE LYING ABOUT IT. DON'T YOU LIE TO ME, IAN.

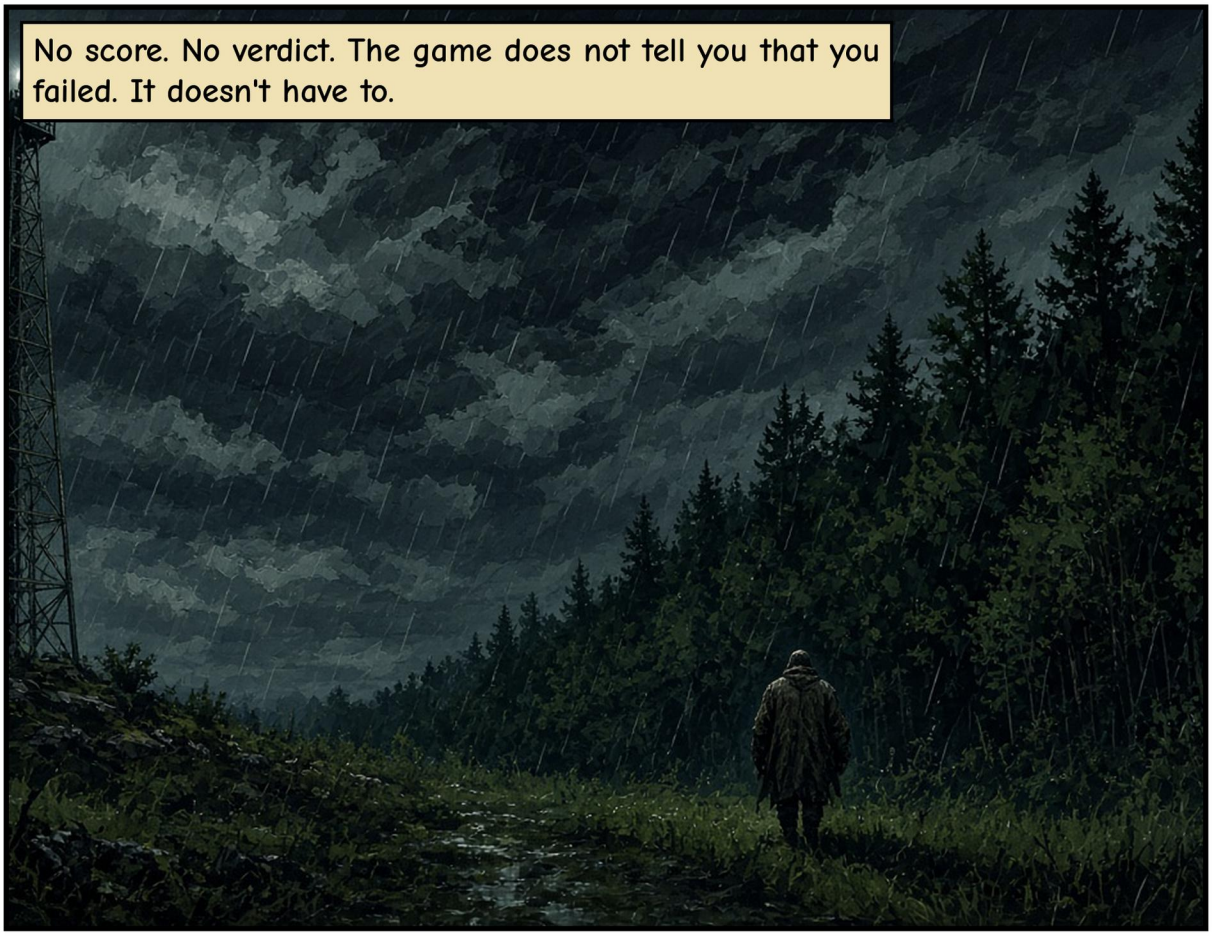

Control does not cut to black. It continues, as infected-Ian. The world is now written in heartbeats and currents of smell. Human tools are gone. The voice is gone. The objective is not.


He does not wave back. He can't. He keeps walking. That is the most human thing left in him: he keeps walking.

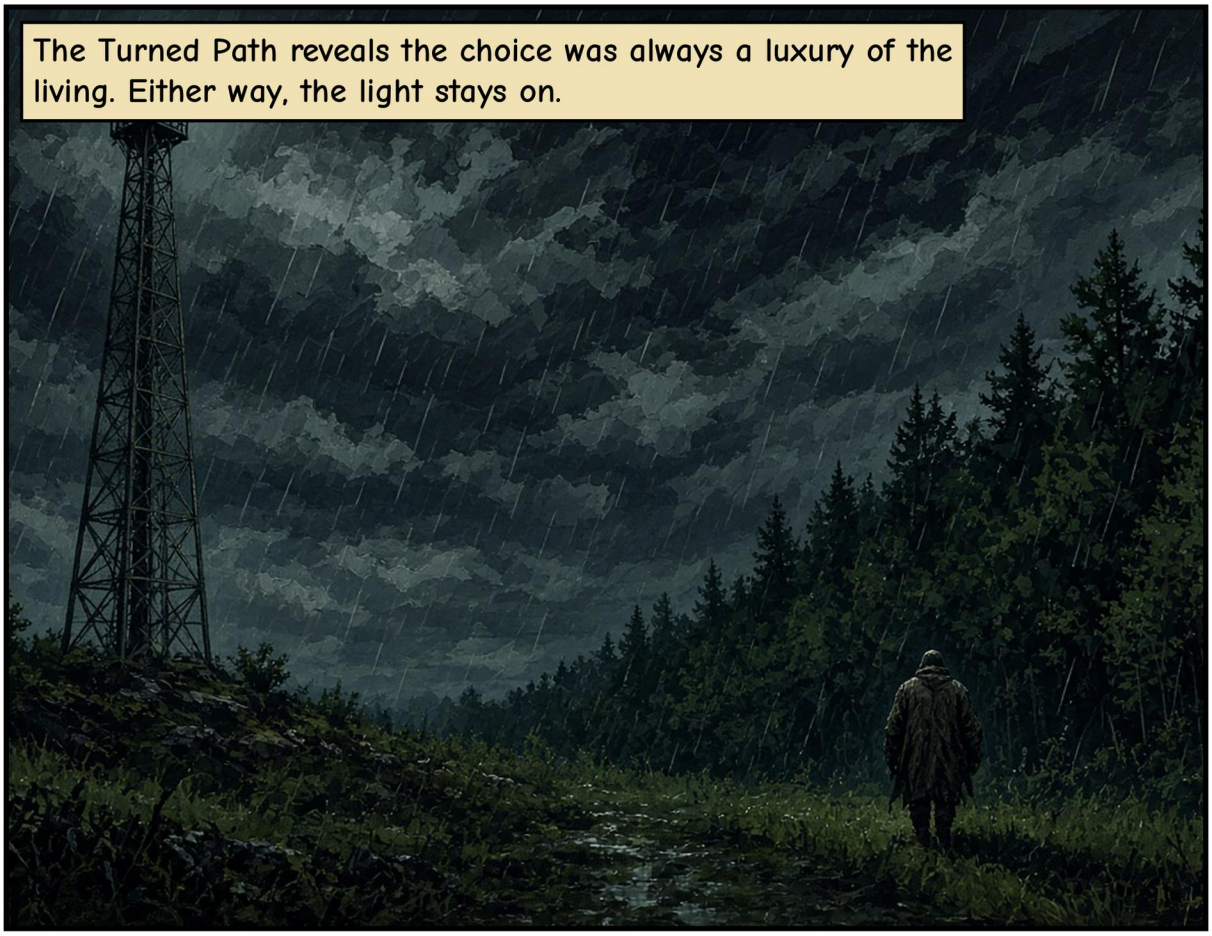

Jeff walks him through the green dark one last time. It is the only guided sequence in this whole second game, and the quietest.
JEFF
I KNOW IT'S YOU IN THERE. YOU DON'T GET TO LEAVE ME TOO.


It is the bravest thing in the game.


The city is not saved. It is no longer silent. Neither was he, at the end.


No score. No verdict. The game does not tell you that you failed. It doesn't have to.


The standard path asks a living man to choose between truth and mercy.


The Turned Path reveals the choice was always a luxury of the living. Either way, the light stays on.


THE END